

BOOK ONE // THE METHOD CO.

THE LAST HUMAN JOB

*The careers AI is replacing before **2030** — and
the five questions that tell you if yours is safe.*

DISCLAIMER

READ THIS FIRST.

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The data, studies, company examples, and statistics in these pages are drawn from public reports, news coverage, and published research available at the time of writing. Figures are attributed to their sources throughout, and a full reference list appears at the end of this book.

Nothing here constitutes financial, legal, or career advice for your specific situation. The labour market is moving quickly and figures may shift after publication. Decisions about your own work and career are yours to make — ideally with input from professionals who know your circumstances.

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INSIDE THIS GUIDE

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AI is not coming. It already arrived. The only question now is which job is left for you.

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INTRODUCTION // 00.00

00 — e.g. a city at dawn, an empty office
or browser files

THIS IS NOT A DRILL

*In April 2026, one government
stopped talking about the future and
started building it. The rest of this
book is about what that means for
you.*

THE METHOD CO. // INTRO

On April 23, 2026, the United Arab Emirates announced something no government had announced before. Within two years, half of the country's government sectors, services, and operations will run on agentic AI. Not chatbots. Not help desks. Autonomous systems that monitor, analyse, decide, and execute without a person prompting each step.

The announcement, made under the directives of the UAE President by Sheikh Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, makes the UAE the first government on earth to commit to this at scale. Weeks later, the Cabinet approved a programme to retrain 80,000 federal employees for the shift.

Read that twice. A national government looked at agentic AI and decided it was ready to hand over half its operations. The work that thousands of civil servants used to do — processing, drafting, scheduling, reviewing — is being redesigned around machines that do not clock out.

**If a government will do
this to its own workforce,
ask what a private
company chasing
margins will do to yours.**

This is not a technology story. It is a jobs story. The AI conversation has been dominated by demos, funding rounds, and arguments about whether the machines are conscious. None of that pays your rent. What pays your rent is a job — and a specific set of jobs is being hollowed out right now, in 2026, while most of the people doing them have no idea how exposed they are.

Who this book is for. This is for the person in the middle. Not the founder, not the engineer building the models, not the executive who will be fine either way. It is for the account manager, the bookkeeper, the paralegal, the copywriter, the support agent, the translator, the junior analyst — people who do real, skilled work and have started to feel a draft under the door.

What this book promises. No hype. No false comfort. By the last page you will understand three things: why this wave of automation is different from every one before it; exactly which roles are being thinned out, with real companies and real numbers attached; and how to read your own job honestly and tell whether you are standing on solid ground or on a trapdoor.

This book does not end in despair. The people who come through the next five years in good shape will not be the ones who panicked, and not the ones who pretended nothing was happening. They will be the ones who saw it early and moved first. This book is the warning. The next one is the plan.

50%

of UAE government operations to run on agentic AI within 2 years

SRC // UAE GOV, APR 2026

80k

federal employees being retrained for the AI transition

SRC // UAE CABINET

13%

drop in employment for 22–25 year-olds in AI-exposed roles

SRC // STANFORD, 2025

CHAPTER 01 // 01.00



CH 01 image — server racks, infrastructure, quiet machinery
or browser files

THE SHIFT NOBODY ANNOUNCED

*AI did not arrive with a press
conference for your industry. It
arrived as a quiet upgrade — and
then it started doing the work.*

THE METHOD CO. // CH 01

Three years ago, AI was a toy. You typed something clever into a box and it wrote you a poem, and everyone shared screenshots. It was impressive and useless in roughly equal measure. That phase is over. In about three years, AI moved from a novelty you played with to infrastructure that companies quietly run their operations on.

The shift was not announced to the people it affects. There was no memo to the world's bookkeepers, support agents, or junior designers warning them their work was about to be partially absorbed. It happened the way real change always happens — as a series of small, sensible business decisions that each looked harmless on its own.

Reactive AI versus agentic AI. The AI most people met first is reactive. It waits for you to ask, then it answers. Useful, but it sits still until you push it — a very smart intern who only does the exact thing you describe, one thing at a time.

Agentic AI is a different animal. Give it a goal and it plans the steps, connects to the systems it needs, and executes a whole sequence of actions without being told what to do at each stage.

Say *"set up the project kickoff with the team."* A reactive tool drafts an email you then send. An agentic system checks everyone's calendars, finds the slot that works, sends the invites, reads the recent project emails, builds a draft agenda, and after the meeting sends a summary to everyone who attended. You gave one instruction. It did the job.

The last wave took the task. This one takes the first rung of the ladder.

Why this wave is different. Every generation has its automation panic, and every time the optimists were proved right. The spreadsheet did not end accounting. The ATM did not end banking. So why not stay calm? Because the previous waves automated routine and manual work. What they left almost entirely alone was cognitive work — judgement, language, analysis. This wave moves cognitive work. It reads, writes, summarises, reasons over rules, and drafts at a level that covers most of the everyday output of a great many office jobs.

The entry-level trap. AI is strongest at exactly the kind of work that used to be a beginner's job – the repetitive drafting, the basic research, the standard documents, the simple tickets. That work was never glamorous, but it was how people got in the door and learned the craft. When a machine absorbs the entry-level work, the entry-level job stops being worth hiring for. The ladder loses its bottom rung.

What companies say versus what they do. Watch behaviour, not press releases. Klarna said publicly that an AI assistant built with OpenAI was doing the work of 700 customer-service agents, and its headcount fell sharply over the same period. JP Morgan's leadership has signalled it expects to run with fewer people as AI takes on more. Major global law firms have cut hundreds of support roles and named AI as part of the reason. The reassuring public language and the quiet restructuring are two different conversations. This book is about the second one.

02



Ch.02 image — empty desks, a closed door, abandoned workstation
or browse files

CHAPTER 02 // 02.00

THE REPLACED

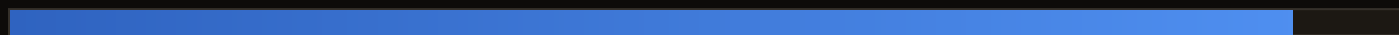
*Nine careers AI is taking. What each
job was, what the machine took,
what the evidence shows — and what
is left for humans.*

THE METHOD CO. // CH 02

A HEAT MAP OF WHERE THE GROUND IS MOVING.

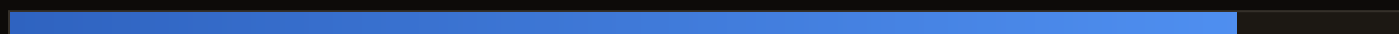
// HIGHER BAR = MORE OF THE WORK BEING ABSORBED // INDICATIVE

Volume translation



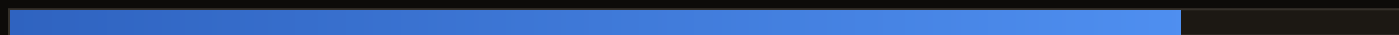
92

Tier-1 customer service



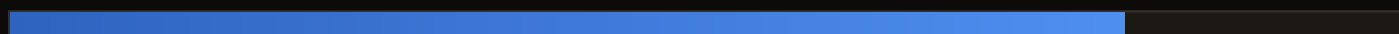
88

Data entry & admin



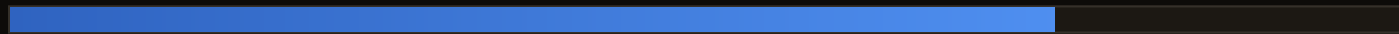
84

Stock illustration



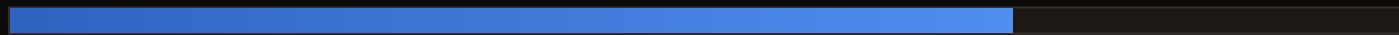
80

Junior paralegal work



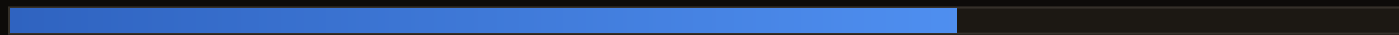
75

Volume copywriting



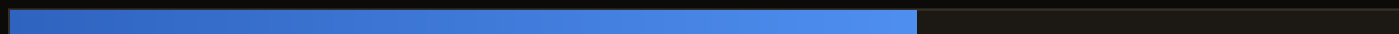
72

Junior accounting



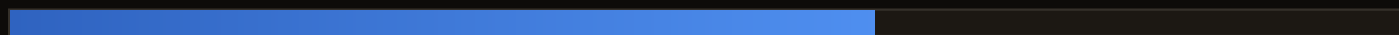
68

Routine code & tests



65

Retail till & bank counter



62

ROLE 01 **Call Centre & Customer Service Agents**

A first job for millions: answer the phone, follow the script, solve the common problem, escalate the rare one. Structured, repeatable – exactly the work today's AI handles well. Klarna became the case study the whole industry watched. In early 2024 it announced an OpenAI-built assistant handling about two-thirds of its customer-service chats, the equivalent of 700 full-time agents, resolving issues in under two minutes instead of eleven.

Then came the lesson. By 2025 the company admitted it had cut too far – quality had slipped on complex and emotional cases – and it began bringing humans back. The model that settled into place is the one now spreading everywhere: the machine takes the high-volume, repetitive 80%, humans keep the complex, emotional 20%. For the workforce, the front door to the profession is closing.

VERDICT

The job survives in a smaller, more senior form. The on-ramp that let ordinary people start a career here is closing fast.

A translator converts text between languages; a localiser adapts the whole thing for a culture – the references, the jokes, the tone. Machine translation came for the volume first. Tools like DeepL and the latest generative models now produce usable text in seconds for the bulk of commercial work: manuals, contracts, product descriptions, subtitles. Per-word rates have collapsed, and translators have lost clients they held for a decade.

What survives is the work where a mistake is expensive or the voice is the point – literary translation where rhythm and authorial voice matter, and high-stakes legal and medical translation where an error has real consequences and no company wants a machine carrying that risk alone.

VERDICT

Volume translation is largely gone to machines. The premium, high-risk, and creative end is still firmly human.

Administrative Assistants & Data Entry Clerks

The work that keeps an office running and never reaches the customer: scheduling, inbox triage, document handling, entering data into systems. Tasks with clear rules and a clear beginning, middle, and end — precisely what agentic AI eats. The system that checks calendars, sends invites, builds the agenda from old emails, and circulates the summary is doing the core of an assistant's day, on its own, at any hour.

The loss here is quiet. There is no dramatic headline when a company simply stops replacing the assistant who left. But this was a first formal job for an enormous number of people — a way into professional life — and it is shrinking at scale without anyone announcing it.

VERDICT

One of the most exposed roles of all. Disappearing silently, which makes it easy to underestimate.

Bank Tellers & Retail Cashiers

This decline began 50 years ago with the cash machine and sped up with mobile banking. AI is finishing the job. A landmark 2013 Oxford study by Frey and Osborne put the automation risk for roles like these above 90% – and the years since have largely proved it right.

The signals keep coming. JP Morgan's leadership has said AI has already shifted work inside the bank and expects fewer staff ahead. Bank of America's internal assistant, Erica, has cut internal support demand sharply. Branch counts fall almost every year, digital-first banks run with almost no human tellers, and in retail the customer now does the scanning at self-checkout.

VERDICT

A long, slow decline now in its final phase. The roles that remain are few and increasingly specialised.

Junior Copywriters & Content Writers

Someone has to write the product descriptions, the marketing emails, the social posts, the ad scripts. For years that someone was a junior writer building a portfolio one small job at a time. Reports point to a steep drop in entry-level copywriting listings across 2024 and 2025 – one of the sharpest falls in any single creative category in that window.

The cause is direct. Models like ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini produce competent volume copy in seconds. What they do not produce is a real brand voice, an original campaign idea, or a position in the market that makes a company memorable. A widely cited Forrester report found many employers came to regret AI-driven layoffs – but rehiring tends to come back smaller, aimed at supervising the machine.

VERDICT

Volume writing is being absorbed. Strategy, voice, and original ideas are where writers still win.

Commercial Illustrators & Volume Designers

Image models like Midjourney and DALL·E turned a text description into finished artwork in seconds. Book covers, banners, blog illustrations, event posters, product art – much of the everyday commercial demand can now be generated cheaply. A 2025 survey by the Association of Illustrators in the UK reported that a large share of respondents had already lost work to AI.

The line is clear. High-volume, generic work is going. High-concept work survives – brand identity, art direction, original illustration with a point of view. But the entry rung, the small jobs where a beginner learned the craft, is vanishing.

VERDICT

Volume design is being automated. Conceptual and brand-defining work remains valuable, but the way in is disappearing.

Paralegals & Junior Legal Researchers

The paralegal does the operational work beside the lawyer: reviewing contracts, searching case law, organising documents, drafting standard clauses, checking the fine print. Structured, rule-bound work — exactly where AI moved first in law. Tools trained on legal text now read thousands of pages in minutes, flag the critical terms, compare clauses, and assemble a draft report. Baker McKenzie announced cuts of hundreds of support roles, with AI named as part of the reason.

There is a deeper problem here. The senior lawyer of the future learns the craft by grinding through exactly this junior work. Cut the junior roles today and you thin the pool of experienced lawyers a decade from now.

VERDICT

The junior tier is being compressed hard. Survivors supervise the machine — but there are fewer seats.

Junior Accountants & Fiscal Analysts

Invoicing, reconciliation, monthly close, expense checks, report building — the financial back office runs on structured tasks over clean data, the definition of work a machine does well. McKinsey has estimated that a large share of finance activity is already automatable with today's technology.

The obvious objection is the spreadsheet, which people said would end accounting in the 1990s. Instead the raw calculation shrank and accountants climbed into advisory roles. But the size of the leap is different now. The spreadsheet automated the calculation; AI automates the interpretation, the reasoning over rules, the recommendation. The senior accountant is still valuable — but the path that led there has narrowed sharply.

VERDICT

The senior advisory role holds. The junior route that produced those seniors is being cut off.

Junior Software Developers

Here is the twist: AI is cutting the entry door to the very industry that built it. The junior developer traditionally learns by doing the simple work — writing routine code, building tests, generating documentation — which is exactly what AI coding tools now do fastest. The 2025 Stanford study "*Canaries in the Coal Mine*" drew on payroll records for millions of US workers and found employment for developers aged 22–25 fell sharply in AI-exposed roles, a relative decline of 13–16%, while employment for older, experienced developers held steady or grew.

And here is the paradox. Controlled research from METR in 2025 found experienced developers on complex tasks in their own projects were actually *slower* when leaning on AI — by around 19%. The machine helps with the simple and gets in the way on the genuinely hard. So companies keep the seniors and stop hiring the juniors.

VERDICT

Seniors are safe and in demand. The junior pipeline is breaking — and that is a time bomb for the whole field.

**If no one is
hired as a
junior today,
where does
the senior of
2035 come
from?**

03



Ch 03 Image — repeating pattern, grid, machinery detail
or browse files

CHAPTER 03 // 03.00

THE PATTERN

*Nine different roles. One shared
shape. Once you see the pattern, you
can spot the risk anywhere —
including in your own job.*

THE METHOD CO. // CH 03

Look back across the nine roles and the same shape repeats. None of them was killed because the workers were bad at the job. They were exposed because of how the work itself is built. When a role scores high on all three of the traits below, it is in the danger zone.

TRAIT 01

Repetition

The work follows a pattern that recurs. The same shape of task, over and over, with predictable inputs.

TRAIT 02

Rule-based logic

The right answer can be reached by following rules, rather than reading a room or weighing values.

TRAIT 03

Low contextual stakes

A small error is cheap and recoverable, so no one needs a human to carry the risk.

The real story is the entry level. Notice what kept surfacing. It was rarely the senior who went first — it was the junior, the assistant, the analyst, the trainee. AI is strongest at the simple, structured work that entry-level jobs are made of, so those are the jobs that stop being worth hiring for.

This is not only about jobs lost. It is about careers that can no longer begin.

The compounding effect. Today's seniors are safe because they carry judgement the machine cannot match — judgement built over years of junior work. Cut the junior roles now and in a decade the senior bench is thin, because the pipeline that filled it was switched off. The damage from a hiring decision made today does not fully land until years later, which is exactly why it is so easy to ignore.

04



Ch.04 Image — a figure at a crossroads, a gauge, a dial
or browser files

CHAPTER 04 // 04.00

WHERE DO YOU STAND?

*Five honest questions. Answer them
about your own role and you will
know whether you are on solid
ground — or standing on a trapdoor.*

THE METHOD CO. // CH 04

YOU DON'T NEED A CONSULTANT. YOU NEED **FIVE HONEST ANSWERS.**

SOLID GROUND

DRIFT ZONE

TRAPDOOR

Score yourself across the five questions below. The more "yes, rule-based, commodity, replaceable" answers, the further right you sit. The point is not panic — it is to see clearly enough to act.

01 **Is your core work rule-based or judgement-based?**

If most of what you do follows clear rules, you are more exposed. If it depends on weighing trade-offs with no clean right answer, you are safer.

02 **Does it require emotional or relational intelligence?**

Reading a room, defusing a tense client, building trust over time. Machines are weak here — and that weakness is your moat.

03 **Is your output a commodity, or is it contextual?**

If your work is interchangeable with anyone else's doing the same task, it is a commodity and at risk. If it only makes sense in the context you bring, it is harder to automate.

04 **Does your value depend on accumulated human trust?**

Relationships, reputation, and credibility built over years do not transfer to a machine. The more your value lives in trust, the safer you are.

05

Could a good prompt replace most of your morning?

The blunt one. Picture your tasks before lunch. How many could a capable person hand to an AI and get back something usable?

**A task is not
a career. The
people who
got replaced
confused the
two. The
people who
thrive
separated
them in time.**

— VICTOR MIRANDA

05

CHAPTER 05 // 05.00

05 image — sunrise, an open road, a horizon
or browser files

THIS IS THE TURNING POINT

*Not a doom story. A clarity story.
The advantage now belongs to
whoever sees this first — and moves.*

THE METHOD CO. // CH 05

Everything in this book points one way, and it is not toward despair. Yes, the ground is moving. Yes, specific roles are being hollowed out, and the entry level is taking the hardest hit. But fear is not a strategy, and neither is denial. The people who come through the next five years in good shape will not be the most technically gifted or the luckiest. They will be the ones who looked at this clearly and acted before they were forced to.

That is the whole game now. Not "learn to code." Not "panic and retrain into something random." The real move is to get clear on what makes you genuinely valuable – the part of your work that is judgement, trust, context, and originality – and to build your role around that before the market decides for you.

This book was the diagnosis. It told you where the danger is and how to spot it. What it deliberately did not give you is the cure, because the cure deserves its own book. There is a clear path forward. It is specific, it is doable, and it starts with one idea most people get wrong: **positioning**. Not retraining, not posting more, not chasing every new tool. Getting clear on what you are known for and making the market see it.

KEEP GOING

The next book is **the plan**.

The Method Co. was built for exactly this moment – helping people and businesses get clear before the market decides for them. Book Two, "*Stay Hireable*," is where the diagnosis becomes a 90-day plan you can actually run.

themethodco.co/stay-hireable →

ABOUT

THE METHOD CO.

The Method Co. is a positioning and strategy consultancy based in Dublin, founded by Victor Miranda. We help service businesses and professionals get clear on who they are, what they offer, and how to communicate it in a way the market actually responds to.

The work spans positioning, copywriting, funnel strategy, landing-page builds, paid-ads direction, and digital clarity audits. It runs on a simple four-step framework: **Diagnose, Design, Deploy, Deliver**. The aim is always the same — to turn a vague, easily-replaced presence into a clear, valuable, and memorable one.

THEMETHODCO.CO · @THEMETHODCO.CO

**Get clear before the
market decides for you.**

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▲ VERIFY BEFORE PUBLISHING

Confirm exact current figures before going live, as they shift over time: GitHub Copilot subscriber count and growth, the Association of Illustrators survey percentage, the Forrester employer-regret figure, the McKinsey finance-automation percentage, and Bank of America Erica usage stats. The UAE, Klarna, Stanford, Oxford, and METR claims are verified as of writing.